

Which GST Provider for My Project?

Project: Credit Signal Report - look up a buyer's GSTIN and read their filing history, compliance and turnover signals to judge credit risk.

RECOMMENDED: Karza (now part of Perfios)

Karza's GST stack was purpose-built for lending and underwriting. It returns exactly the signals our risk model needs - filing history (GSTR-1 / GSTR-3B), compliance gaps, cancellation/suspension and derived turnover - not just "is this GSTIN valid". It is the closest fit to a credit-signal product.

Why it fits this project

- Built for credit decisions - used widely by lenders/NBFCs for automated underwriting.
- Deep data: filing-history depth + compliance scoring + turnover estimation feed our weighted score.
- Strong reputation for data intelligence and fraud signals (useful for red flags).
- Handles the GSTN tunnel for us - no GSP licence or government contract needed.

Ranked for our use case

#	Provider	Role	Why
1	Karza (Perfios)	PRIMARY	Deepest credit/filing-history signals; built for underwriting.
2	Clear (ClearTax)	ALTERNATIVE	A real GSP with mature GST APIs; more compliance-native.
3	Surepass	CHEAP PILOT	Affordable, fast to integrate; start here, upgrade for depth.
-	Govt GST portal (GSTN)	NOT FOR MVP	Needs GSP licence: Rs 2-5 cr capital + GSTN contract.

Testing without paying

Layer 1 - Build a MockGstProvider that returns fake but realistic filing/compliance data. Test the whole scoring + report flow offline: no API keys, no rate limits, no payment.

Provider	Free testing	Notes for us
Perfios	10,000+ free sandbox credits	BEST - same stack as Karza; test real signals free
Sandbox.co.in (Quicko)	Free to start; good docs + test cases	Search GSTIN + return-status (compliance) APIs
AppyFlow	50 free requests	Basic verification only - too shallow for scoring
GSTINCheck	20 free requests (email)	Quick smoke test only
Govt GST Developer Portal	Sandbox + sample test keys	Production GSP-gated; sandbox fine for trials

Plan: Develop against MockGstProvider (free, offline) -> validate on Perfios sandbox (10k free credits) -> go live on Karza (Perfios). One swappable GstProvider interface; cache + cost-log every call.